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ALPRENTICE 'BUNCHY' CARTER DEPUTY MINISTER OF DEFENSE BLACK PANTHER PARTY L.A., CALIFORNIA
BORN: OCTOBER 12, 1942 ASSASSINATED: JANUARY 17, 1969.



If we are to commemorate Alprentice Bunchy Carter, let us then remember, especially at this time when the fascist dogs are over-anxious with hunger to crush our people, all oppressed people in the very birth of struggle for the liberation of mankind, let us remember the genius of Bunchy Carter. It was Bunchy who exposed to many of us the true genius of our leader, Minister of Defense, Huey P. Newton. But Bunchy Carter was a wise-practitioner of the ideas of Huey Newton. And that was his genius.

The first Chapter of the Black Panther Party to be formed outside of the Northern California Bay Area was the Southern California Chapter. And Bunchy organized and became the driving force of that Chapter. Following Huey's example, he organized the most wretched and dissatisfied, the baddest, the poorest of Black people, those who hated everything, for everything seemed bent on their destruction, those who only gave respect to another brother because he was badder than them. And that was what Bunchy was. He'd tell you he was the Mayor of the Ghetto. Just about every nigger in Los Angeles knew Bunchy and respected him (if you didn't remember his name, he'd tell you it was Bunchy, like a bunch of greens).

Bunchy had been a Stinson (one of

the largest gangs in Los Angeles - on the Eastside) until he went to prison. He did four years at Soledad, where he became a Muslim and met Eldridge Cleaver. When he got out of prison, he and some of his old partners put together a group known as the Wretched of the Earth (based on the title of one of Frantz Fanon's books). It was a Black Nationalist organization with the goal of liberation of Black people by any means necessary. But this group lasted a very short time, because Bunchy heard about an organization called the Black Panther Party for Self Defense.

In February 1968, the Southern California Chapter of the Black Panther Party was officially opened. And from that time to January, 1969, the genius, the talent of Bunchy Carter flourished and shot a bolt of light, love, revolutionary drive into all of us, and crystallized understanding of the true nature of the dog oppressors and what we needed to do, to implement in deeds to smash the pigs and every last vestige of their insane society.

It was a special quality, a unique understanding and way of getting it across to people that we might remember, that we cannot forget. He would translate for us, tell us in the words of the ghetto, that the alternatives were few, really none. That there was no out, no option. Our liberation,

our survival is dependent upon our fight. Dependent upon the strength of our blows and the magnitude of those blows. He would say that Revolution meant bloodshed and guns. Simple. No way of blocking out that reality. He even said it in poems. "...You know you tired of all this ... / Do something, nigger, if you only spit...".

And for those of us who would dare to say we were Vanguard soldiers, members of the Black Panther Party, the commitment was a price, a shortened life that had to be used in every minute for the benefit of our people. He would remind us that we had no other commitment than to the People through the vehicle of the Black Panther Party. And that if we loved the People and the Party, every day was merely a gift of time to give, to use for spreading the information we have, among the People and dealing death blows to the pigs. He taught that. He was that.

January 17, 1969, bootlickers of the now-defunct black lackey cult known as the US organization assassinated Bunchy Carter. A cult whose only reverence in History will be that they snatched life and breath from Bunchy Carter, that they shortened the time of leadership to his people, and left us bereft. Words are insufficient for that. But we had our view of the man, we knew his work, we loved him, and we remember him.